MONTHLY UPDATE

Cape Verde: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

A municipal council presented a 17-service platform for operation by the end of 2026, and the justice institute counted 46,000 criminal case files handled digitally across all 17 comarcas. The United States compact the country had been selected for was reported terminated in December 2025.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

On 10 September the prime minister named state modernisation and digital transformation among the government's priorities for the new phase of the United Nations partnership, with no framework document or envelope attached. On 16 September a territorial programme for Maio was launched with internet-access, digital-economy and training projects and free internet points in three localities, Fogo to follow; no budget is stated.

Data protection

Oversight of the state's own intelligence capability moved by administrative act rather than statute, and the act is contested. The prime minister's delegation of powers over the Republic's information service to the minister of internal administration was formalised by despacho no 15/2026 in the official gazette, with the opposition calling it unconstitutional, the government invoking the delegation regime provided for in the Organic Law of the Government, and the President of the Republic declining to address it publicly after discussing it with the prime minister. The despacho text is not held, so whether the delegated powers reach communications interception or data access is not established here.

Finance

New investments

At the World Bank's September review mission the task team leader put the Digital Cabo Verde project's original financing at about 80% executed and the additional financing for 2025 to 2028 at about 40%, and school connectivity was named the additional financing's priority.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The national operator and a European exchange operator signed a non-binding letter of intent, announced on 29 September, for a South Atlantic interconnection corridor: transport capacity between Lisbon and Sao Paulo in exchange for access to exchanges in Frankfurt, Madrid, Marseille, New York and Sao Paulo. Scope and commercial terms await a definitive agreement.

Cybersecurity

On 8 September the national postal operator warned customers about fraudulent messages from people impersonating its staff, asking recipients to click a link that is not its own. No message volume, loss figure or referral to a response body is published.

DPI

Data Exchange

The project coordination centre invited expressions of interest on 21 September for a 12-month build of a digital-nomad statistics and data module inside SGIT, to be interoperable with institutional platforms and to produce the Morabeza Innovation Project's indicators automatically, financed from the African Development Bank's credit. The notice does not name the platforms it is to connect to.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Card traffic held steady through August. Residents made 4,992,880 operations worth CVE 21,159.9m on the vinti4 network, 3,768,595 of them card purchases, 0.3 per cent fewer than in July, on the central bank's monthly figures.

Registries

The social registry now has a coverage figure: the UN country team put the Cadastro Social Único at 64% of the population at the government's high-level partnership meeting on 10 September, where discussion of the next cooperation framework, for 2028-2032, opened.

Sectoral management information systems

The justice information system reported on its second year. The justice institute's evaluation, released on 16 September, counts 46,000 criminal case files handled digitally across all 17 comarcas, an estimated 2.3 million sheets of paper saved, 401 justice professionals signing with qualified digital signatures and 110 trained in artificial intelligence; the civil-process component waits on authorisation for three pilots.

Procurement opened behind the announced health digitalisation. Expressions of interest close on 18 September 2026 for a consultancy to train and support use of the health information system, its portal and the open-source district health platform, under a US$29m concessional health-security project. It is a training and support contract rather than a build — which is the part an announced system usually lacks, and the part that decides whether it is used.

Technology

Innovation ecosystem

The innovation record moved to the extent that two institutions said they intend to work together. A company hub for technology firms was announced at a Brazil-Cabo Verde-Portugal business forum in Praia on 4 September and created with a tax number by 17 September, to draw firms in education, technology, IoT hardware and smart cities to the technology park; no investment figure, site or capacity is stated.

Capacity

Literacy

The economy and digital transition minister said his ministry will implement a national digital literacy programme, which already has a manual financed by the World Bank and is to advance through protocols with the public university. No start date, budget or target is stated.

Inclusion

Digital divides

A two-month pilot of training and mentoring in digital business tools for about 250 traders, most of them women, is set to start on Maio in October, before moving to Fogo, Santiago and São Vicente. It is run with the economy and digital transformation ministry.

Data

Open data

The fisheries ministry presented a public Fisheries Information System giving structured access to data on landings, licences, catches, revenues, subsidies and the sector's legal framework at the FAO fisheries committee, built under the fisheries transparency standard the country joined in 2023. No launch date, licence or update frequency is given.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The one United States instrument on the record has gone. The national press reported on 12 September that the third Millennium Challenge compact, whose initial agreement was signed in April 2024, was officially terminated in December 2025 after the corporation's global aid was cut, and that the country is on the eligible list for FY2027 published on 31 August. The ministry responsible gave no answer on whether it will apply.

EU activities

The 14th special partnership ministerial in Brussels on 9 October 2026 reported a Global Gateway digital pipeline in preparation, covering submarine cables and inter-island connectivity, and progress in European support for the national data and AI strategies.

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